OLIVIER KOOI

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Education

University of Chicago, Ph.D. Economics *2019–2025*

University of Chicago, M.A. Economics *2018–2019*

Erasmus University, B.A. Economics and Business Economics *2015–2018*

Employment

London School of Economics, LSE Fellow (Post-doc) *2025–now*

RAND Europe, Senior Research Fellow *September 2026–present*

References

Professor Mikhail Golosov (Chair)
University of Chicago
Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
golosov@uchicago.edu
(773) 702-6405

Professor Rodrigo Adão
University of Chicago
Booth School of Business
rodrigo.adao@chicagobooth.edu
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Professor Luis Garicano
London School of Economics
School of Public Policy
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Professor James Robinson
University of Chicago
Harris School of Public Policy
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Research and Teaching Fields

Primary: Macroeconomics, International Trade
Secondary: Political Economy, Public Finance

Job Market Paper

Industrial Capacity as a Military Deterrent (with Balázs Markó)

Abstract: *Military outcomes depend not only on initial military strength but also on the capacity to expand it during war. We develop a model in which industrial capacity can have a strategic role as a military deterrent and use it to study how governments can sustain peace at the lowest cost. When wars end before wartime production can affect military outcomes, peacetime procurement suffices. When wars can be long, efficient deterrence also requires subsidies to industrial capacity because private investors do not internalize its strategic value as a military deterrent. Optimal policy gives larger subsidies to technologies that can expand output more readily during war. We develop an Integrated Defense Economics Model to quantify the gains from subsidies and identify priority sectors. Relative to a procurement-only benchmark, subsidies raise steady-state welfare and reduce military expenditure while maintaining deterrence. Priority sectors include guided missiles, propulsion units, and ammunition, and the model shows how these priorities vary with the type of conflict being deterred.*

Working Papers

The National Security Argument for Foreign Ownership Restriction (with Rodrigo Adão)

Power & Resilience: On the Theory and Implications of a National Security Externality

Work in Progress

The Theory of the Economic Security Union

Awards, Scholarships, and Grants

Bradley Award	*2023*
Neubauer Family Foundation Distinguished Scholar Doctoral Fellowship	*2019–2024*
University of Chicago Social Sciences Division Fellowship	*2019–2024*

Teaching Experience

London School of Economics

Strategic Policy Making	With Prof. Luis Garicano	

University of Chicago

New Developments in Public Finance (graduate)	TA for Profs. Ganong, Noel and Zwick	*Winter 2023*
Public Finance (graduate)	TA for Prof. Golosov	*Winter 2023*
Price Theory I (graduate)	TA for Prof. Murphy	*Fall 2022*
New Developments in Public Finance (graduate)	TA for Profs. Ganong, Noel and Zwick	*Spring 2022*
Price Theory I (graduate)	TA for Prof. Murphy	*Fall 2021*

Research Experience and Other Employment

Research Assistant for Prof. Josse Delfgaauw, Erasmus University *2017–2018*

Professional Experience

Conferences	*Cowles Conference on International Trade, Minnesota Macro, First double workshop in geoeconomics, geopolitics and preventing conflict studies*
Presentations	*Capital Theory*, *Trade Working Group*, *Political Economy Lunch Seminar*
Refereeing Activity	*Journal of Political Economy*